

Coordinates make analysis precise

Foundations

THE IDEA

Files run a through h and ranks run 1 through 8. A square's name never changes when the board is viewed from Black's side. Accurate coordinates let you reconstruct lessons without relying on a picture.

WORKED EXAMPLE

White's king begins on e1 and Black's on e8. From White's side a1 is the left corner; it is a dark square. A knight described as moving from g1 to f3 has the same move in either board orientation.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

Which squares lie on the a1-h8 diagonal?

ANSWER AND REASONING

a1, b2, c3, d4, e5, f6, g7, and h8. All are dark squares. This diagonal is useful for noticing a bishop or queen aiming at a king from far away.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Say the square names while replaying a line.